itself, as both a supplier and a consumer. It developed operational capabilities based on its understanding of the threat and sought buyers for its goods. Sometimes it succeeded and sometimes it didn't.

For example, there was a platform that was maintained for years without a single IDF buyer and that finally closed down. And then, according to Murphy's Law, an operation was planned. The unit played a significant role in the operation, particularly on the intelligence side. However, had the platform, which no longer existed, been a partner in the operational branch's part in the mission, there is no doubt that the operation would have taken on a completely different character, at least in terms of its fingerprints, and would certainly have served as a precedent for a breakthrough in the innovative combat doctrine of operational branch missions.

Operations are born in one of two ways: either they are assigned as a task by a superior, or they are ideas that grow from the bottom up, usually from intelligence officers who bring it up for discussion with the head of operations. The unit's intelligence officer for many years was Rumi, may he rest in peace, who was one of the founders of the IDF's information security and of the unit's field intelligence. There is no doubt that he had a significant influence on the nature of the unit's operations, especially those that dealt with the thwarting of attacks in base and target countries. Shlomo, as a combat fighter in the IDF and in the unit, shared a common language with Rumi from the moment they met, a language that contributed greatly to the development of the unit's combat doctrine and to the character of its operations.

The relationship between the Mossad and the IDF, especially MI (Military Intelligence Directorate of the IDF), had its ups and downs but was for the most part characterized by negative competition, alongside cooperation that was practically forced upon the commanders. It was in the 1970s when the two sides, Caesarea and MI, identified a discipline whose realization could be made possible only through cooperation that would make optimal use of each party's uniqueness, when Caesarea defined for itself a long-term strategic goal, which became the unit's "pillar of fire."

Shlomo played a crucial role throughout the teething problems and transformation processes involved in this change. The young soldiers had great respect for Shlomo, who had been honored with an IDF citation that he never spoke about, from the days before they were born. Their